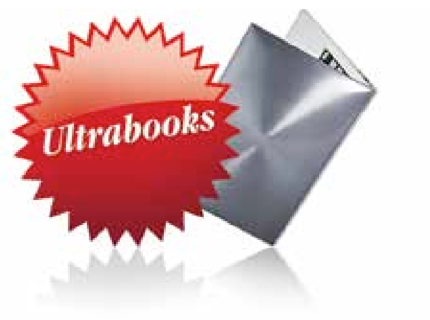
Semi-Professional: Canon 7D (₹87,995)

Making its foray into the market as far back as 2009, the Canon 7D is a camera that shares its DNA with the professional 1D series. It's blazingly fast, capable of shooting 8 fps and boasts a 19 point AF system that is capable of keeping up with almost anything. It's also weather sealed.

Professional: Canon 5D MarkIII (₹2,06,995)

The winner of our DSLR shootout, the Canon 5D MarkIII comes with an exorbitant price tag which is easily justified by how much power is packed into this elegant magnesium alloy shell. 22 megapixels on a full frame sensor and a 61 point AF system right out of the 1Dx make this camera excellent not just for the studio, but also for outdoor and sports work.

Ultrabooks are ultra-light, ultra-sleek, and offer great battery life



If you have been following laptops closely in the past six months, the word 'Ultrabook' isn't new. It's just a buzzword for thin, light, long lasting batteries, and not compromising on performance – or basically what laptops should have been all along. Our guess is that a lot of you are going to go out looking to get one pretty soon, and thus the need for this guide. We must say that we're quite impressed by the overall capability of most Ultrabooks we tested, running on Intel's Core i5 or Core i7 processor, they could easily match and, in some cases, surpass the performance offered by a 15-inch entertainment laptop.

Specs that matter

CPUs

Almost all Ultrabooks we've seen so far either sport Intel Core i5 or i7 processors. Needless to say, these processors are quite powerful and are able to handle every-day apps and multi-tasking quite easily. They also provide very good HD 1080p video decoding for smooth movie playback. Even if you come across low-powered Core i3 processor-based Ultrabooks up for grabs, whether you're a student, professional or home user, it ought to be powerful enough to take on anything you throw at it (apart from gaming). It will function just like a regular laptop, and it will probably perform better and the battery will last longer!

Storage

Higher-capacity hard drives (750GB and above) are rare on mainstream laptops because they're expensive – but we've seen the Samsung Series 5 Ultrabook come equipped with a whopping 1TB internal hard drive. However, most Ultrabooks offer between 320GB to 500GB of storage, if they come with an internal mechanical hard drive. For Ultrabooks that sport a faster SSD, current norms dictate disk capacity between 128GB to 256GB. If you're contemplating an Ultrabook purchase, understand one thing. To gain higher performance, an SSD completes the 'holy triumvirate of performance' when paired with a high-speed processor and fast RAM. If these three things are high-performing, your machine will be high-performing. For users who don't want their Ultrabooks to break performance records, you're much better off opting for an internal hard drive as a storage option. And guess what? That decision will help you save a few thousand rupees easily.

GPU

Should you buy an Ultrabook with on-board graphics or should you shell out a bit extra for that other Ultrabook which has the cool new GPU that everyone's raving about? It's an important buying decision, considering which direction you choose, for it has long-term implications on your Ultrabook's usefulness. NVIDIA and AMD recently released their GeForce 600M and 7000M mobility GPUs, respectively, for use in modern Ultrabooks and laptops. Both manufacturers are extremely competent and both have their pros and cons. But one thing's for sure. If you have intentions of gaming with the latest games on your brand new Ultrabook, definitely opt for one that has either NVIDIA or AMD graphics. If you aren't so enthusiastic about gaming, rest assured that the on-board Intel graphics is more than sufficient for your use.

Screen

It's commendable that screen sizes are getting bigger with Ultrabooks; but disappointing that display resolutions aren't. Everyone seems to have accepted that 1366x768 pixel resolution is good enough, except a few manufacturers that pack higher pixels-per-inch (1600x900) compared to any other Ultrabook with a similar form factor (13-inch). At least for 14 and 15-inch Ultrabooks, the industry should consider introducing higher-resolution displays. We highly recommend getting a first-hand experience of your future Ultrabook's screen quality – pay attention